

The Ultimate Cloud Storage Cost-Saving Cheatsheet

Storing everything in the default cloud tier is like renting a luxury apartment just to keep your old cardboard boxes. By mastering storage tiers, you can slash your company's cloud bill by up to 70% with just a few terminal commands.

What you'll learn:

- 1 Standard vs. Infrequent Access (IA)
- 2 Glacier Deep Archive (The Digital Attic)
- 3 Automating with Lifecycle Policies
- 4 Cleaning Up Old File Versions

Aman Raj Singh

Cloud Operations Engineer @ iManage

linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

1

TIP 1 OF 4

Standard vs. Infrequent Access (IA)

Standard storage is lightning-fast but costs the most. Infrequent Access (IA) cuts storage costs in half because you promise only to access the files once or twice a month. However, reading files from IA costs a small retrieval fee, so only use it for older assets.

```
$aws s3 cp document.pdf s3://my-bucket/ --storage-class STANDARD_IA
```

Cloud & DevOps Daily

Cloud Storage Tiers: Save 70% on AWS/GCP/Azure Costs

Monday, August 31, 2026

Swipe to tip 2 >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

2

TIP 2 OF 4

Glacier Deep Archive (The Digital Attic)

This is the cheapest storage tier available in the cloud, costing fractions of a penny per gigabyte. The catch is retrieval time: getting your files back can take up to 12 hours. Use this for historical backups that you hope you never have to open.

```
$aws s3 cp year-2022-backups.tar.gz s3://my-bucket/ --storage-class DEEP_ARCHIVE
```

Cloud & DevOps Daily

Cloud Storage Tiers: Save 70% on AWS/GCP/Azure Costs

Monday, August 31, 2026

Swipe to tip 3 >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

3

TIP 3 OF 4

Automating with Lifecycle Policies

You don't need to manually move files to cheaper tiers. Instead, write a simple JSON configuration file. This policy tells the cloud provider to automatically transition files to cheaper tiers as they age, completely hands-free.

```
$aws s3api put-bucket-lifecycle-configuration --bucket my-logs-bucket --lifecycle-configuration '{"Ru
```

Cloud & DevOps Daily

Cloud Storage Tiers: Save 70% on AWS/GCP/Azure Costs

Monday, August 31, 2026

Swipe to tip 4 >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

4

TIP 4 OF 4

Cleaning Up Old File Versions

When you enable 'versioning' to protect against accidental deletes, AWS keeps every single change you make to a file. This can secretly double or triple your storage bill. Use a lifecycle rule to permanently delete older, noncurrent versions after a set time.

```
$aws s3api put-bucket-lifecycle-configuration --bucket my-bucket --lifecycle-configuration '{"Rules":
```


Cloud & DevOps Daily

Cloud Storage Tiers: Save 70% on AWS/GCP/Azure Costs

Monday, August 31, 2026

See Key Takeaways on next page >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

Key Takeaways

- + Standard tier has no retrieval fees but has the highest monthly storage cost.
- + Infrequent Access (IA) has a 30-day minimum storage charge, so don't delete files immediately.
- + Glacier Deep Archive is perfect for compliance data you can wait 12 hours to access.
- + Always set up lifecycle rules early in a project to avoid surprise bills later.
- + Use AWS S3 Storage Lens (it's free) to visualize which buckets are costing you the most.

Watch Out For

- ! Storing files smaller than 128KB in IA tiers (you still get billed for 128KB minimum per file).
- ! Retrieving files from Glacier frequently (the retrieval fees will quickly wipe out your savings).
- ! Deleting files from Glacier before 90 or 180 days (this triggers early deletion penalty fees).
- ! Leaving versioning turned on without an expiration rule to clean up old, hidden file versions.

Follow for daily Cloud & DevOps guides!

[linkedin.com/in/mrmanrajsingh](https://www.linkedin.com/in/mrmanrajsingh)